Homework 08
REAL VARIABLES I
Fall 2026

Due: 2026-11-01 19:00
Topics: Hölder's inequality with several factors, sharpness of exponents, testing property of L^p norms, log-convexity of L^p norms.

Instructions

Submission is through Gradescope, accessible through Blackboard.
Grading rubric: Every problem/subproblem is graded according to this rubric (no intermediate scores):

- **0%**: No submission or no meaningful content.
- **30%**: Attempt at solution, outline of idea.
- **60%**: Serious attempt at solution. Solution fails to address important points.
- **80%**: Solutions with fixable mistakes or incompleteness.
- **100%**: Complete and correct solution.

You may receive up to a 10% penalty for very unclear or messy exposition.
Please start every solution on a separate page. Clearly mark the pages associated to every part. You may submit either computer typeset solutions or handwritten solutions. Handwritten solutions must be *very clearly* legible.
You are encouraged to work in groups. You may submit the entire homework assignment as a group (up to 4 people). If you only did some exercises as a group, instead of a solution you may clearly indicate whose submission I should look at for the solution to the problem.
Indicate any external help/notes/resources you used. You may not use generative AI in any way to help you with the HW.

In all problems, $(X, \mathcal{E}, \mu)$ is a measure space, f, g, f_j are measurable functions, and $\|\cdot\|_{L^p}$ is allowed to take the value $+\infty$; inequalities are understood in $[0, +\infty]$. For $p \in (1, \infty)$, p' denotes the conjugate exponent, $\frac{1}{p} + \frac{1}{p'} = 1$.

1. (Hölder's inequality with several factors)

1.a (weight: 1.0) Let $N \geq 1$ and $r, p_1, \dots, p_N \in (1, \infty)$ with $\frac{1}{r} = \sum_{j=1}^N \frac{1}{p_j}$. Prove that

$$\Big\| \prod_{j=1}^N f_j \Big\|_{L^r(X,\mu)} \leq \prod_{j=1}^N \|f_j\|_{L^{p_j}(X,\mu)}.$$

Free hint.

- You may use Hölder's inequality with two factors and exponents $p, p' \in (1, \infty)$.
- Induct on N, or reduce to the case $r = 1$ by applying that case to $|f_j|^r$.
- Treat separately the case where some $\|f_j\|_{L^{p_j}}$ is 0 or $+\infty$.

2. (Log-convexity of L^p norms)

2.a (weight: 1.0) Let $1 \leq p_0 \leq p_1 \leq \infty$, $\theta \in [0, 1]$, and $\frac{1}{p_\theta} \coloneqq \frac{1-\theta}{p_0} + \frac{\theta}{p_1}$. Prove that

$$\|f\|_{L^{p_\theta}(X,\mu)} \leq \|f\|^{1-\theta}_{L^{p_0}(X,\mu)} \|f\|^{\theta}_{L^{p_1}(X,\mu)}.$$

3. (Sharpness of Hölder's inequality)

Let $(X, \mathcal{E}, \mu)$ be a measure space with a set of positive finite measure, and let $p, q, r \in [1, \infty)$. Consider the inequality

$$\|fg\|_{L^r(X,\mu)} \leq C \|f\|_{L^p(X,\mu)} \|g\|_{L^q(X,\mu)} \qquad (*)$$

for all measurable f, g, with a constant $C \in [0, \infty)$ independent of f, g.

3.a (weight: 0.5) Suppose $(*)$ holds.

- If $\frac{1}{r} > \frac{1}{p} + \frac{1}{q}$, prove that $\sup\{\mu(E) : E \in \mathcal{E},\ \mu(E) < \infty\} < \infty$, and determine the optimal value of C in terms of this supremum and p, q, r.
- If $\frac{1}{r} < \frac{1}{p} + \frac{1}{q}$, prove that $\inf\{\mu(E) : E \in \mathcal{E},\ \mu(E) > 0\} > 0$, and determine the optimal value of C in terms of this infimum and p, q, r.

3.b (weight: 0.3)

- Conversely, suppose $\mu(X) < \infty$ (so the supremum in (a) equals $\mu(X)$). Prove that $(*)$ holds for any $\frac{1}{r} \geq \frac{1}{p} + \frac{1}{q}$ with the optimal constant you determined above .
- Conversely, suppose the infimum in (a) is positive. Prove that $(*)$ holds for any $\frac{1}{r} \leq \frac{1}{p} + \frac{1}{q}$ with the optimal constant you determined above.

3.c (weight: 0.2) Give examples of a space and two functions and exponents $p, q, r \in [1, \infty)$ such that

$$\|fg\|_{L^r} = +\infty, \qquad \|f\|_{L^p} = 1, \|f\|_{L^q} = 1$$

with $\frac{1}{r} > \frac{1}{p} + \frac{1}{q}$. Separately given an example for which

$$\|fg\|_{L^r} = +\infty, \qquad \|f\|_{L^p} = 1, \|f\|_{L^q} = 1$$

with $\frac{1}{r} < \frac{1}{p} + \frac{1}{q}$.

4. (Testing property of L^p norms)

IN CLASS

Let $(X, \mathcal{E}, \mu)$ be σ-finite, $p \in (1, \infty)$, and let $f\colon X \to \mathbb{R}$ be measurable.

4.a (weight: 0.6) Prove that

$$\|f\|_{L^p(X,\mu)} = \sup\Big\{ \int_X \Big| fg \, \mathrm{d}\mu \Big| : \|g\|_{L^{p'}(X,\mu)} < 1 \Big\}.$$

4.b (weight: 0.4) Prove that

$$\|f\|_{L^p(X,\mu)} = \sup\Big\{ \Big| \int_X fg \, \mathrm{d}\mu \Big| : \|g\|_{L^{p'}(X,\mu)} < 1,\ g \text{ simple} \Big\}.$$

Free hint.

- Make sure to address the case $\|f\|_{L^p} = +\infty$: you must show that the supremum is then also $+\infty$.
- For $\|f\|_{L^p} = \infty$, truncate: replace f by $f \mathbb{1}_{X_n \cap \{|f| \leq n\}}$ with $X_n \uparrow X$ of finite measure.
- For (b), approximate the test function from (a) by simple functions; control the error.